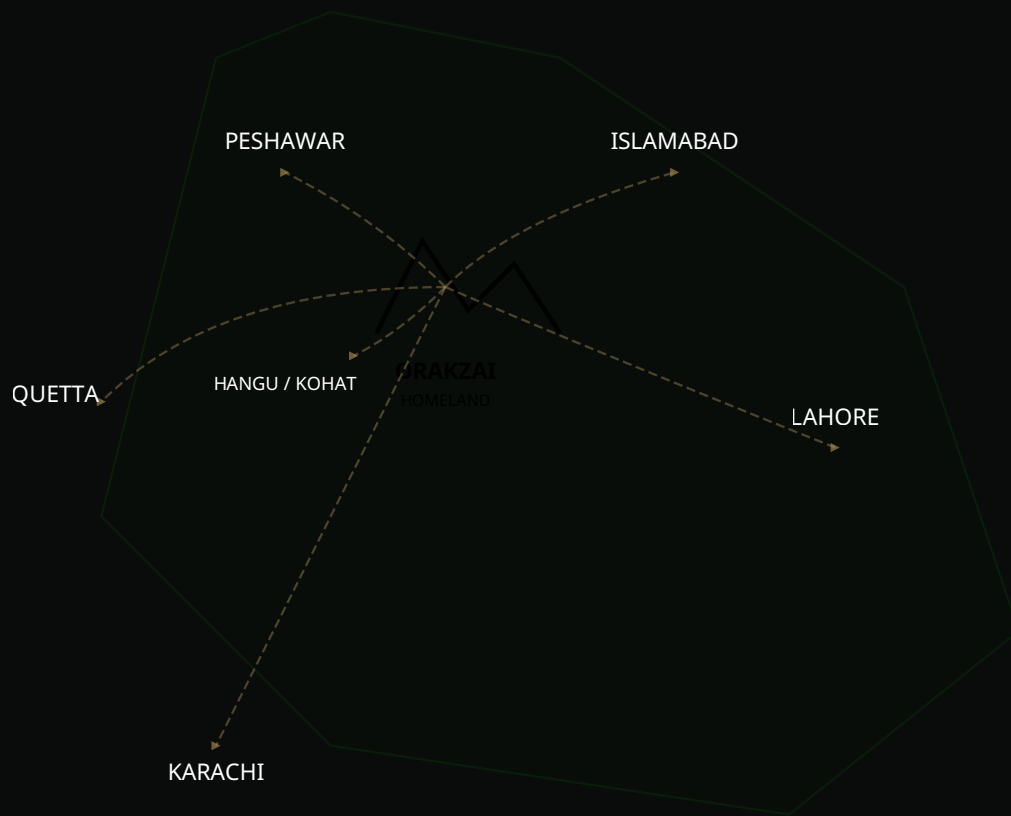


ORAKZAI ACROSS PAKISTAN

“From one homeland to many places.”

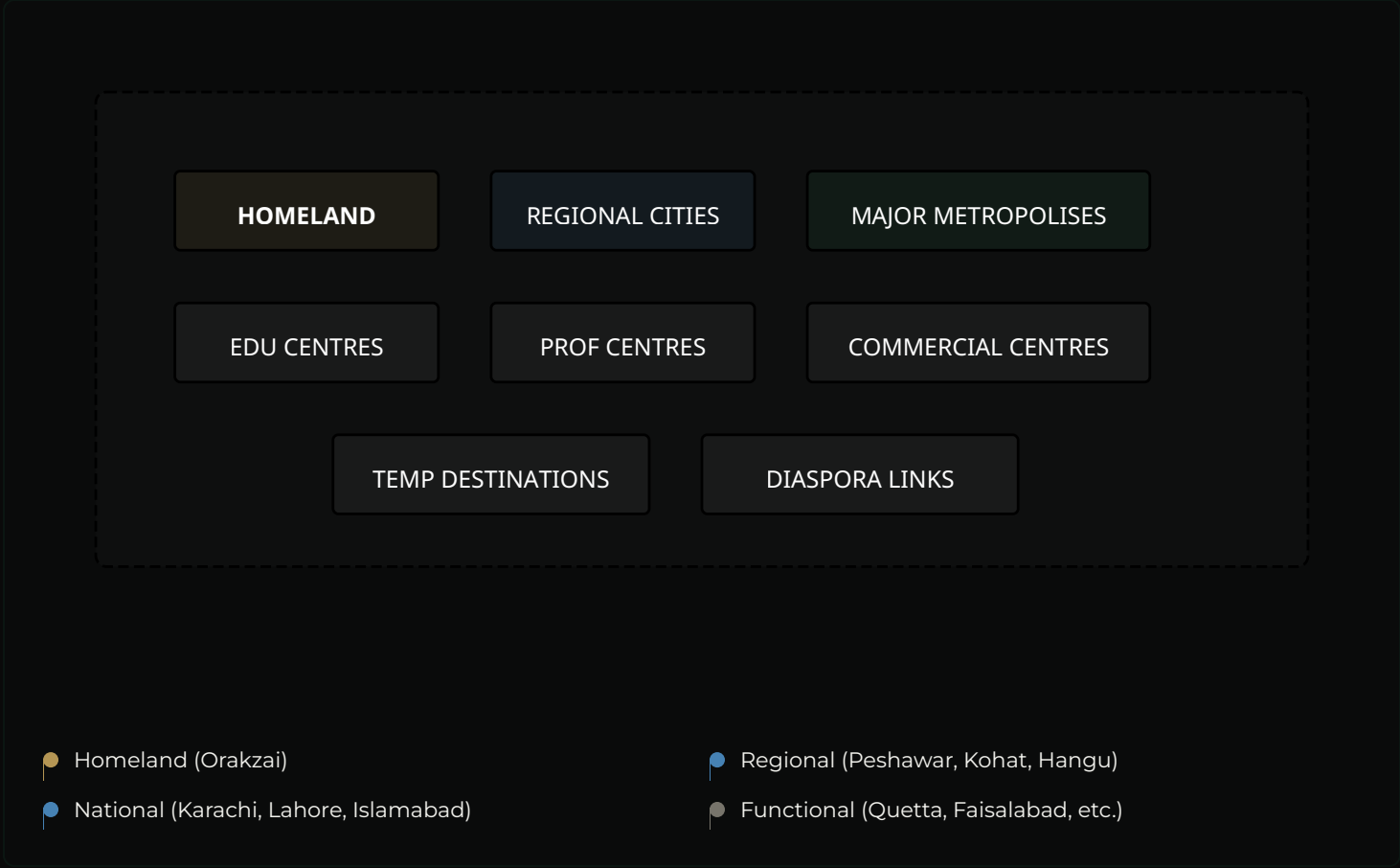
Orakzai is a homeland. But Orakzai identity is not confined to one district. Families move. Students leave for universities. Workers follow opportunity. Professionals build careers. Businesses cross provincial boundaries. Children grow up in cities their grandparents may never have known. Some families return regularly. Some remain connected through visits. Some through phone calls. Some through photographs, stories and language. And some carry the homeland quietly, through memory. Across Pakistan, the Orakzai story therefore becomes a story of movement. From mountains to cities. From villages to universities. From local markets to national economies. From one generation to another. The geography changes. The identity can continue. But the national story must be told carefully. The presence of Pashtuns in a city does not automatically mean the presence of Orakzais. The migration of former-FATA communities does not automatically tell the story of Orakzai families. And a single family story cannot become a population statistic. To understand Orakzai across Pakistan, evidence and memory must be read together.



“The documented mobility pathways from the Orakzai homeland to major urban centers across Pakistan.”

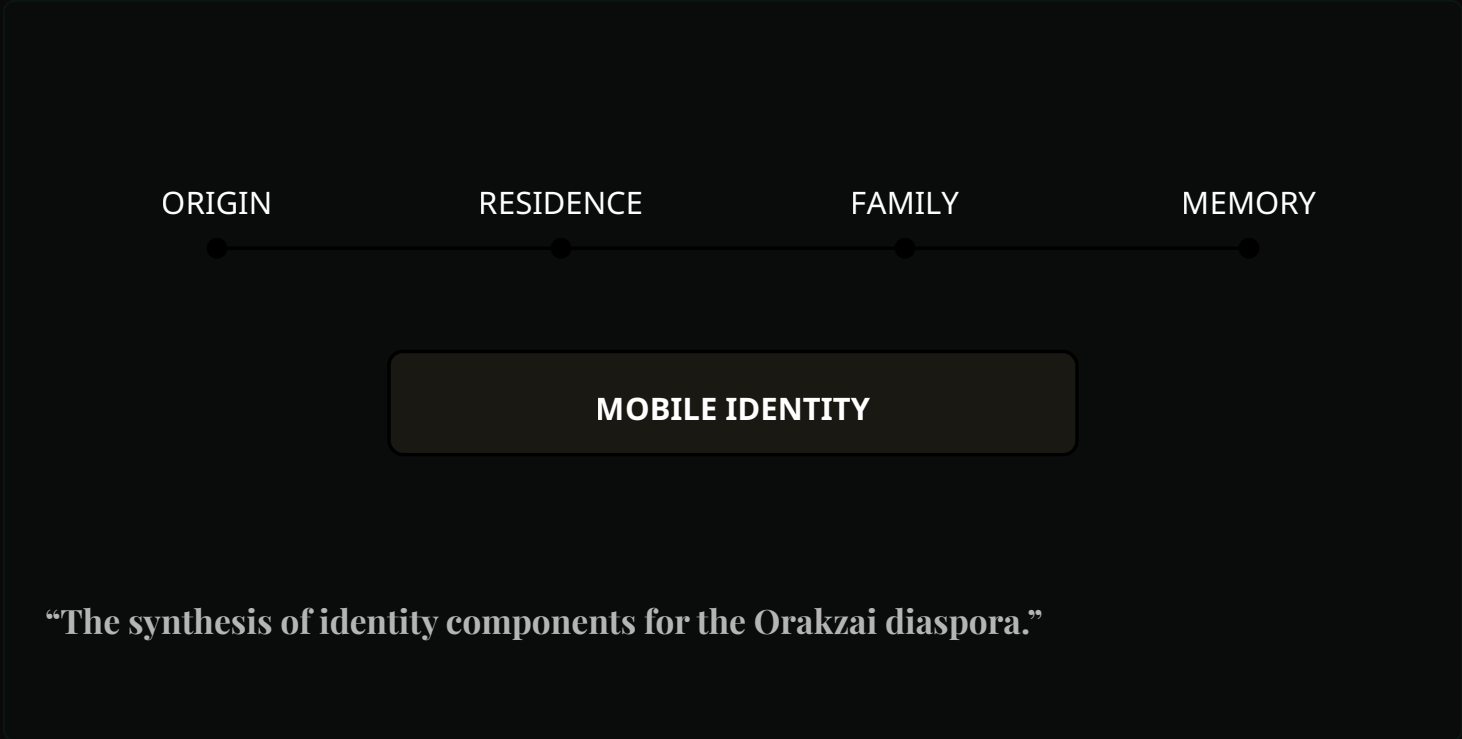
PLACES OF ORAKZAI MOBILITY

This conceptual map illustrates documented or plausible mobility pathways, not population size. It categorizes destinations based on their functional roles in the Orakzai story, from regional service centers to national professional hubs.⁴



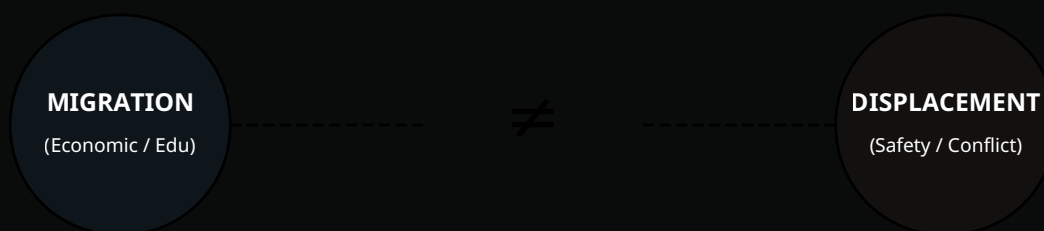
WHAT DOES “ORAKZAI ACROSS PAKISTAN” MEAN?

The presence of the Orakzai people outside their district is defined by three distinct concepts: individuals born in the homeland who have moved, families with Orakzai ancestry established elsewhere, and those who maintain deep cultural and property connections despite their urban residence. This creates a "mobile identity" that bridges geography and heritage.



VOLUNTARY MIGRATION VS. DISPLACEMENT

The history of the Orakzai people includes both voluntary economic migration and forced displacement due to conflict. A 2016 UNHCR Return Intention Survey documented the intentions of families displaced from Orakzai Agency, highlighting that 27% cited destroyed housing as a major challenge to their return. It is critical to distinguish between those who move for opportunity and those who seek safety.^{1 3}



“The conceptual distinction between voluntary movement and forced displacement.”

REGIONAL MOBILITY CHAIN

Proximity to neighboring districts creates a natural regional mobility chain. Movement often flows from the Orakzai valleys to Hangu and Kohat for immediate services, and then to Peshawar for provincial-level education and healthcare. This regional network forms the foundation of Orakzai urban presence in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa.^{3 4}

ORAKZAI — HANGU — KOHAT — PESHAWAR — BEYOND

“The regional mobility pathway within the Kohat Division and Khyber Pakhtunkhwa.”

AUTHOR'S REFLECTION

To see Orakzai across Pakistan is to see a people who have refused to be limited by their geography. Our story is no longer only a story of mountains; it is a story of how those mountains travel with us. Whether in the busy markets of Karachi, the offices of Islamabad, or the lecture halls of Lahore, the Orakzai heart remains recognizable. We move not to leave our identity behind, but to give it a larger stage. Every student who graduates from a national university, every worker who supports a family back home, and every professional who builds a career in the city is a testament to our resilience. We are one people, connected by blood and memory, living across a vast and diverse nation. We are Orakzai, and we are everywhere that opportunity and dignity call us.

“FROM ONE HOMELAND TO A NATIONAL PRESENCE.”

NATIONAL ORAKZAI MOBILITY ANALYSIS
